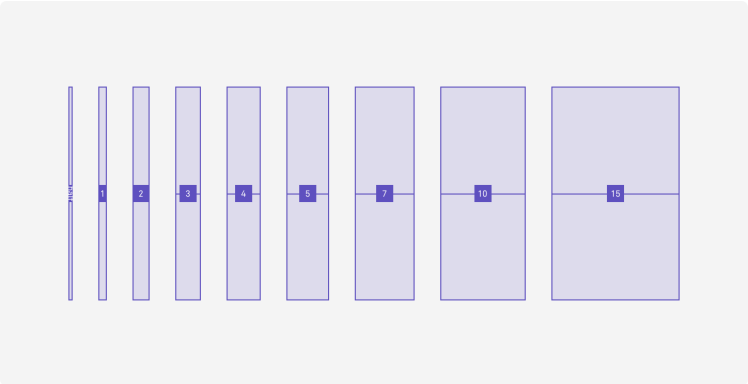
Spacing

Created by Genevieve Lake, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 18 Feb 2021



Version

1

Availability

Web

Android

iOS

On This Page

- Rationale
- Spacing Scale
- Key Terms

Use the spacing scale when designing components. The spacing scale is based on multiples of 8 with 2 exceptions; a 4pt half step and a 12pt step. For web, the spacing scale can be applied to `margin` or `padding` properties.

Designer Links

NA

Developer Links

- Web Playground
- React Playground
- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Rationale

The spacing scale has been designed to provide consistency and render harmonious visual displays. Consistent alignment of elements is an essential part of good UI design and improves user experience.

Spacing Scale

Recommended usage describes where the spacing should be applied.

Base = smaller spacing that can be used within components eg. the space between a label and text input.

Layout = larger spacing blocks used to disassociate sections eg. the spacing between two components.

Name	rem	dp / pt / px	Example	Recommended usage
spacingHalf	0.25	4		Base
spacing1x	0.5	8		Base
spacing1nHalf	0.75	12	1nHalf	Base
spacing2x	1	16	2	Base
spacing3x	1.5	24	3	Base
spacing4x	2	32	4	Base / Layout
spacing5x	2.5	40	5	Layout
spacing7x	3.5	56	7	Layout
spacing10x	5	80	10	Layout
spacing15x	7.5	120	15	Layout

Key Terms

Term	Definition
Spacing scale	A set of non-linear spacing values to be used when designing and developing.
rem (default)	Rem is a web unit which represents the font-size of the root element. Rem is the default unit for spacing, however px can also be used.
dp / pt / px	dp = Android density-independent pixels pt = iOS points px = Web pixels

No labels